SSC CHSL 2020 Tier-I question paper with answers

5 August 2021 · Shift 2

66 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 34 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20211105175401/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerKeys_%20CHSLE2020_05112021.pdf

English Language 24 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. What are the "options available of me" for a change of career?

(A) options available over me
(B) options available from me
(C) options available to me
(D) No substitution required

Q.2

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Instrument that measures the altitude of the land surface

(A) Altimeter
(B) Thermometer
(C) Barometer
(D) Chronometer

Q.3

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. "If the box breaking" the glass bottle will be shattered.

(A) If the box break
(B) If the box breaks
(C) If the box broke
(D) No substitution required

Q.4

Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the right order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph. A. Due to this tilt as the Earth wobbles around the Sun, different points of the Earth receive more or less sunlight. B. Furthermore, we also wouldn't have solstices or equinoxes. C. We know that seasons are caused by the Earth having a slight tilt on its axis. D. If the Sun just shone directly on the Equator all year long, we would be left without seasons.

(A) CBDA
(B) ABCD
(C) ACBD
(D) CADB

Q.5

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Naïve

(A) Simple
(B) Sophisticated
(C) Immature
(D) Unsuspicious

Q.6

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. The energy required / for perform various functions of the body / is obtained from food.

(A) for perform various functions of the body
(B) is obtained from food
(C) The energy required
(D) No error

Q.7

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Aptitude
(B) Attitude
(C) Altitude
(D) Attaractive

Q.8

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. A micromanager frequently demands reports and updates leaving little room for subordinates to take _____ on their own.

(A) decisions
(B) results
(C) verdicts
(D) decrees

Q.9

Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the right order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph. A. Games involved gladiators fighting wild animals or each other. B. Inside, tiered seating encircled the arena, where animals were caged and stage sets prepared. C. Inaugurated in AD 80, the 50,000-seat Colosseum is also known as the Flavian Amphitheatre. D. Rome's great gladiatorial arena is the most monumental of the city's ancient sights.

(A) ADCB
(B) BCAD
(C) DABC
(D) DCBA

Q.10

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Compel

(A) Induce
(B) Influence
(C) Dissuade
(D) Persuade

Q.11

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. The first van was sent as a _____ to mislead the thugs.

(A) persuasion
(B) decoy
(C) determination
(D) temptation

Q.12

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Salient

(A) Sturdy
(B) Navigable
(C) Marine
(D) Noticeable

Q.13

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Apathetic

(A) Instantaneous
(B) Irrelevant
(C) Irregular
(D) Indifferent

Q.14

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Butter fingers

(A) To be very efficient
(B) To like rich food
(C) To cook well
(D) To be clumsy

Q.15

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. The monkeys swinged / on the branches and / jumped over the compound wall.

(A) The monkeys swinged
(B) No error
(C) on the branches and
(D) jumped over the compound wall

Q.16

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech. Neil Armstrong said, "It's a small step for man but a giant leap for mankind."

(A) Neil Armstrong said that a small step for man can be giant leap for mankind.
(B) Neil Armstrong had said that a small step for man is a giant leap for mankind.
(C) Neil Armstrong said that it was a small step for man but a giant leap for mankind.
(D) Neil Armstrong says that was a small step for man but a giant leap for mankind.

Q.17

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice. Have you submitted the papers at the post office?

(A) Have the papers been submit by you at the post office?
(B) Had the papers submitted by you to the post office?
(C) Has the papers been submitted by you at the post office?
(D) Have the papers been submitted by you at the post office?

Q.18

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A place or scene of activity, debate, or conflict

(A) Stadium
(B) Floor
(C) Arena
(D) Site

Q.20

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Large-hearted

(A) Corrupt
(B) Unhealthy
(C) Overweight
(D) Generous

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In the generation of hydroelectric power, water is collected or (1) _____ at a higher elevation and led downward (2) _____ large pipes to a lower elevation; the difference in elevations is (3) _____ as the head. At the end of its passage down the pipes, the falling water (4) _____ turbines to rotate. The turbines in turn drive generators, (5) _____ convert the turbines' mechanical energy into electricity.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.1.

(A) hoarded
(B) amassed
(C) stored
(D) deposited

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In the generation of hydroelectric power, water is collected or (1) _____ at a higher elevation and led downward (2) _____ large pipes to a lower elevation; the difference in elevations is (3) _____ as the head. At the end of its passage down the pipes, the falling water (4) _____ turbines to rotate. The turbines in turn drive generators, (5) _____ convert the turbines' mechanical energy into electricity.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.2.

(A) beyond
(B) above
(C) through
(D) over

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In the generation of hydroelectric power, water is collected or (1) _____ at a higher elevation and led downward (2) _____ large pipes to a lower elevation; the difference in elevations is (3) _____ as the head. At the end of its passage down the pipes, the falling water (4) _____ turbines to rotate. The turbines in turn drive generators, (5) _____ convert the turbines' mechanical energy into electricity.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.3.

(A) known
(B) being known
(C) told
(D) know

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In the generation of hydroelectric power, water is collected or (1) _____ at a higher elevation and led downward (2) _____ large pipes to a lower elevation; the difference in elevations is (3) _____ as the head. At the end of its passage down the pipes, the falling water (4) _____ turbines to rotate. The turbines in turn drive generators, (5) _____ convert the turbines' mechanical energy into electricity.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.4.

(A) produces
(B) begins
(C) effects
(D) causes

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In the generation of hydroelectric power, water is collected or (1) _____ at a higher elevation and led downward (2) _____ large pipes to a lower elevation; the difference in elevations is (3) _____ as the head. At the end of its passage down the pipes, the falling water (4) _____ turbines to rotate. The turbines in turn drive generators, (5) _____ convert the turbines' mechanical energy into electricity.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.5.

(A) they
(B) whose
(C) which
(D) who

General Intelligence 18 questions

Q.1

Select the option that is related to the third term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term.
QUORATE : AEOQRTU :: SANDBOX : ?

(A) DNASXOB
(B) ASDNOBX
(C) ABDNOSX
(D) BOXSAND

Q.2

Select the option in which the numbers share the same relationship as that shared by the given pair of numbers. 12 : 20

(A) 30 : 42
(B) 24 : 36
(C) 42 : 57
(D) 18 : 28

Q.6

Select the correct option that indicates the arrangement of the given words in the order in which they appear in an English dictionary. 1. Expanse 2. Expansive 3. Expandable 4. Expansion 5. Expanded

(A) 3-2-1-5-4
(B) 3-5-1-4-2
(C) 1-2-5-3-4
(D) 5-3-1-2-4

Q.7

Tushar is the only son of Jitendra, and Kirti is the daughter of Jitendra's father's brother. Suhani is the sister of Tushar. How is Suhani related to Kirti?

(A) Sister
(B) Cousin
(C) Aunt
(D) Niece

Q.9

Select the option in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following set. (72, 56, 42)

(A) (80, 48, 24)
(B) (132, 110, 90)
(C) (80, 68, 58)
(D) (126, 102, 80)

Q.11

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: Some ducks are hens. Some hens are chickens. Conclusions: I. Some ducks are chickens. II. Some hens are ducks.

(A) Neither conclusion I nor II follows.
(B) Only conclusion II follows.
(C) Both conclusions I and II follow.
(D) Only conclusion I follows.

Q.13

Select the option in which the words share the same relationship as that shared by the given pair of words. Virus : Ebola

(A) Bacteria : Plague
(B) Mosquito : Jaundice
(C) Fungi : Diarrhoea
(D) Season : Common cold

Q.14

A notebook costs ₹12 each. A pen costs ₹9 each. Tina spends ₹123 on a total of 11 pieces of these articles. How many notebooks did she purchase?

(A) 11
(B) 8
(C) 6
(D) 9

Q.15

In a certain code language, ENVELOPE is written as IQZHPRTH. How will INTIMATE be written in that language?

(A) NRYMREYI
(B) KPVKOCVG
(C) LPWPCWG
(D) MQXLQDXH

Q.16

Select the option in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following set.
221 : 348 : 517

(A) 995 : 1326 : 1723
(B) 1005 : 1336 : 1733
(C) 1331 : 1728 : 2744
(D) 343 : 512 : 729

Q.17

Which two digits and signs need to be interchanged so as to balance the given equation? 97 ÷ 24 – 16 × 5 + 37 = 53

(A) 2 and 3; ÷ and –
(B) 7 and 6; + and –
(C) 4 and 7; ÷ and +
(D) 2 and 3; + and ×

Q.18

Four letter-clusters have been given in the options, out of which three are alike in some manner and one is different. Select the letter-cluster that is different.

(A) ORVA
(B) EHLQ
(C) ILPU
(D) KOSW

Q.19

Four numbers have been given in the options, out of which three are alike in some manner and one is different. Select the number that is different.

(A) 345
(B) 514
(C) 733
(D) 218

Q.20

Four words have been given, out of which three are alike in some manner and one is different. Select the word that is different.

(A) Geology
(B) Entomology
(C) Mycology
(D) Genomics

Q.21

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series.
12, 22, 40, 74, 140, ?

(A) 280
(B) 268
(C) 270
(D) 274

Q.23

Select the option that is related to the third word in the same way as the second word is related to the first word. Hindi : Devanagari :: English : ?

(A) Greek
(B) British
(C) Persian
(D) Latin

Q.24

In a certain code language, BOOTLACE is coded as 49960372 and CAPELIN is coded as 7382015. How will TAPIOCA be coded in that language?

(A) 3673819
(B) 6381973
(C) 6582975
(D) 5381963

Q.25

Select the combination of letters that when sequentially placed in the blanks of the given series will complete the series. O _ E _ O Z _ T _ Z _ T

(A) O E T Z T
(B) E Z T O E
(C) Z T E O E
(D) T E Z O Z

General Awareness 24 questions

Q.1

Who among the following politicians was the Home Minister of India in Rajiv Gandhi's cabinet from 1986 to 1989?

(A) Madhavrao Scindia
(B) Ajit Kumar Panja
(C) Buta Singh
(D) Ashoke Kumar Sen

Q.2

Which maharaja of Manipur signed the Instrument of Accession with the Government of India?

(A) Kulachandra Singh
(B) Bodhchandra Singh
(C) Nara Singh
(D) Gambhir Singh

Q.4

The world's only floating national park, Keibul Lamjao National Park, is located in _____.

(A) Manipur
(B) Assam
(C) Nagaland
(D) Tripura

Q.5

Which of the following is a Kharif crop in North India and a Rabi crop in South India?

(A) Wheat
(B) Sesamum
(C) Finger millet
(D) Barley

Q.6

Which of the following is a single user operating system?

(A) Windows 7
(B) MS-DOS
(C) Windows NT
(D) Linux

Q.7

In January 2021, the Defence Research Development Organisation (DRDO) developed India's first indigenous machine pistol called ‘Asmi’ in collaboration with _____.

(A) Army War College, Mhow
(B) Central Ordnance Depot, Jabalpur
(C) Infantry School, Mhow
(D) College of Military Engineering, Pune

Q.8

How many terabytes make one petabyte?

(A) 1048
(B) 1042
(C) 1084
(D) 1024

Q.9

Public Sector Banks account for about _____ of market share in Indian banking as per the Economic Survey 2019-20.

(A) 70%
(B) 50%
(C) 80%
(D) 40%

Q.10
Who among the following did the Sports Authority of India appoint as the middle-and-long distance coach of the Indian athletics team in January 2021?

(A) Avinash Sable
(B) Radhakrishnan Nair
(C) Adille Sumariwalla
(D) Nikolai Snesarev

Q.11
The inertia of an object is measured by its _____.

(A) volume
(B) speed
(C) mass
(D) area

Q.12
Which of the following beaches was NOT awarded the international 'Blue Flag' certification by Foundation of Environment Education, Denmark as of October 2020?

(A) Kappad
(B) Ghoghla
(C) Talasari
(D) Rushikonda

Q.13
Which web portal and mobile application did the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs, Government of India, launch in December 2020?

(A) e-Uparjan
(B) e-Rozgar
(C) e-Sampada
(D) e-Dharti

Q.14
Who among the following was a World War II veteran, also associated with cricket?

(A) Brad Friedel
(B) Alan Burgess
(C) Ivan Cordoba
(D) Erik Karlsson

Q.15
Which of the following Articles of the Constitution of India deals with the organisation of agriculture and animal husbandry?

(A) Article 84
(B) Article 92
(C) Article 29
(D) Article 48

Q.16
The Sufi shrine Charar-e-Sharief (or Sharif) is located near _____ city.

(A) Srinagar
(B) Mumbai
(C) Hyderabad
(D) Lucknow

Q.17
Which of the following watershed development projects is sponsored by the Central Government aims at enabling the rural population to conserve water?

(A) Jal Kranti Abhiyan
(B) Haryali
(C) Neeru-Meeru
(D) Arvary Pani Sansad

Q.18
Which was the first empire in ancient India to use elephants in its war on a large scale?

(A) Shunga
(B) Chola
(C) Kushans
(D) Magadha

Q.19

'Purusha Sukta' is a hymn from which Veda?

(A) Atharvaveda
(B) Yajurveda
(C) Rigveda
(D) Samaveda

Q.20

Which of the following was the country in focus at the 51st International Film Festival of India held in Goa in January 2021?

(A) Myanmar
(B) Nepal
(C) Bangladesh
(D) Bhutan

Q.21

Who discovered blood circulation?

(A) Charles Darwin
(B) David Baltimore
(C) William Harvey
(D) Rosalind Franklin

Q.22

Which of the following diseases is caused by Leishmania, a protozoan organism?

(A) Sleeping sickness
(B) Kala-azar
(C) Malaria
(D) Acne

Q.23

Which of the following is a main species of moist deciduous forests?

(A) Sandalwood
(B) Khejri
(C) Amaltas
(D) Neem

Q.24

A Shadava Raga has only _____ notes in its scale.

(A) seven
(B) eight
(C) five
(D) six

Q.25

As per Union Budget 2021, 9% of the government revenue will be spent on _____.

(A) defence
(B) interest payments
(C) pensions
(D) centrally sponsored schemes

Answer key

English Language

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(D)**	Q.25 **(C)**

General Intelligence

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.6 **(B)**	Q.7 **(D)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.11 **(B)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(B)**	Q.25 **(C)**

General Awareness

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(B)**	Q.7 **(C)**
Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.13 **(C)**
Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(C)**
Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(D)**	Q.25 **(D)**

Explanations

English Language

Q.1 · Answer (C) options available to me

Something is available 'to' someone: 'What are the options available to me for a change of career?'

Q.2 · Answer (A) Altimeter

An altimeter measures altitude; a barometer measures air pressure, a thermometer temperature and a chronometer time.

Q.3 · Answer (B) If the box breaks

A first conditional takes the present simple in the 'if' clause and 'will' in the main clause: 'If the box breaks, the glass bottle will be shattered.'

Q.4 · Answer (D) CADB

C says the seasons come from the Earth's tilt, A explains the effect of that tilt, D imagines the Sun shining on the Equator all year, and B adds a further consequence: CADB.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Sophisticated

'Naïve' means lacking experience or judgement; its opposite is 'sophisticated'. 'Simple', 'immature' and 'unsuspicious' are close to synonyms.

Q.6 · Answer (A) for perform various functions of the body

After the preposition 'for' the verb takes the -ing form: 'for performing various functions of the body' (or 'to perform').

Q.7 · Answer (D) Attaractive

The correct spelling is 'attractive'.

Q.8 · Answer (A) decisions

Subordinates 'take decisions' on their own; 'verdicts' and 'decrees' are pronounced by courts and rulers.

Q.9 · Answer (D) DCBA

D introduces Rome's great gladiatorial arena, C names and dates it, B describes its inside and A the games held there: DCBA.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Dissuade

To 'compel' is to force someone to do something; its opposite is 'dissuade', to persuade someone not to. 'Induce', 'influence' and 'persuade' are close in meaning to 'compel'.

Q.11 · Answer (B) decoy

A 'decoy' is something used to mislead or lure: the first van was sent out to draw the thugs away.

Q.12 · Answer (D) Noticeable

'Salient' means most noticeable or important: 'noticeable'.

Q.13 · Answer (D) Indifferent

'Apathetic' means showing no interest or concern: 'indifferent'.

Q.14 · Answer (D) To be clumsy

'Butter fingers' describes a clumsy person who keeps dropping things.

Q.15 · Answer (A) The monkeys swinged

The past tense of 'swing' is 'swung': 'The monkeys swung on the branches'.

Q.16 · Answer (C) Neil Armstrong said that it was a small step for man but a giant leap for mankind.

The reporting verb 'said' is in the past, so 'it is' becomes 'it was', introduced by 'that'; the rest of the statement is unchanged.

Q.17 · Answer (D) Have the papers been submitted by you at the post office?
The present perfect question becomes 'Have the papers been submitted by you': 'have' agrees with the plural 'papers' and is followed by 'been' and the past participle.

Q.18 · Answer (C) Arena
An arena is a place or scene of activity, debate or conflict.

Q.20 · Answer (D) Generous
A large-hearted person is kind and generous.

Q.21 · Answer (C) stored
Water is collected or 'stored' at a height; 'hoarded' and 'amassed' are used of goods or wealth gathered up.

Q.22 · Answer (C) through
The water is led downward 'through' large pipes.

Q.23 · Answer (A) known
The difference in elevations 'is known as' the head: the passive needs the past participle 'known'.

Q.24 · Answer (D) causes
The pattern 'cause something to do' fits: the falling water 'causes' the turbines to rotate.

Q.25 · Answer (C) which
'Which' refers back to the generators, which are things; 'who' is for people and 'whose' shows possession.

General Intelligence

Q.1 · Answer (C) ABDNOSX
The letters are rearranged in alphabetical order: QUORATE → AEOQRTU. SANDBOX in alphabetical order is ABDNOSX.

Q.2 · Answer (A) 30 : 42
12 = 3 × 4 and 20 = 4 × 5: products of consecutive numbers, the second pair starting where the first ends. Likewise 30 = 5 × 6 and 42 = 6 × 7.

Q.6 · Answer (B) 3-5-1-4-2
In dictionary order: Expandable (3), Expanded (5), Expanse (1), Expansion (4), Expansive (2). 'Expanda' comes before 'Expande', 'Expanse' before 'Expansi', and 'Expansio' before 'Expansiv'.

Q.7 · Answer (D) Niece
SSC's key gives niece. Suhani, Tushar's sister, is Jitendra's daughter, and Kirti, the daughter of Jitendra's father's brother, is Jitendra's cousin. So Suhani is the daughter of Kirti's cousin, a generation below Kirti, and the key follows the common usage that calls a cousin's daughter a niece (strictly, she is Kirti's first cousin once removed).

Q.9 · Answer (B) (132, 110, 90)
72 = 9 × 8, 56 = 8 × 7 and 42 = 7 × 6. Likewise 132 = 12 × 11, 110 = 11 × 10 and 90 = 10 × 9.

Q.11 · Answer (B) Only conclusion II follows.
'Some ducks are hens' can be turned round: some hens are ducks (II). The hens that are chickens need not be the ones that are ducks, so I does not follow.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Bacteria : Plague
Ebola is a disease caused by a virus; plague is a disease caused by a bacterium (Yersinia pestis).

Q.14 · Answer (B) 8
If she bought n notebooks, 12n + 9(11 − n) = 123, so 3n + 99 = 123 and n = 8.

Q.15 · Answer (D) MQXLQDXH
The letters move +4 and +3 in turn: E → I, N → Q, V → Z, E → H and so on. INTIMATE: I → M, N → Q, T → X, I → L, M → Q, A → D, T → X, E → H: MQXLQDXH.

Q.16 · Answer (B) 1005 : 1336 : 1733
221 = 6^3 + 5, 348 = 7^3 + 5 and 517 = 8^3 + 5. Likewise 1005 = 10^3 + 5, 1336 = 11^3 + 5 and 1733 = 12^3 + 5.

Q.17 · Answer (B) 7 and 6; + and –
Interchanging 7 and 6, and + and –: 96 ÷ 24 + 17 × 5 – 36 = 4 + 85 – 36 = 53.

Q.18 · Answer (D) KOSW
EHLQ, ILPU and ORVA move +3, +4, +5 (V + 5 wraps round to A). KOSW moves +4, +4, +4, so it is the odd one.

Q.19 · Answer (C) 733
733 is a prime number. 345 (= 3 × 5 × 23), 514 (= 2 × 257) and 218 (= 2 × 109) are not.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Geology
Entomology (insects), mycology (fungi) and genomics (genomes) study living things; geology studies the Earth's rocks and structure.

Q.21 · Answer (C) 270
Each term is twice the one before minus an even number rising by 2: 12 × 2 – 2 = 22, 22 × 2 – 4 = 40, 40 × 2 – 6 = 74, 74 × 2 – 8 = 140, and 140 × 2 – 10 = 270.

Q.23 · Answer (D) Latin
Hindi is written in the Devanagari script, and English in the Latin (Roman) script.

Q.24 · Answer (B) 6381973
Each letter has its own digit: BOOTLACE gives T = 6, A = 3, O = 9 and C = 7, and CAPELIN gives P = 8 and I = 1. So TAPIOCA is 6381973.

Q.25 · Answer (C) Z T E O E
With Z, T, E, O, E in the blanks the block OZET repeats: OZET OZET OZET.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (C) Buta Singh
Buta Singh was Union Home Minister from 1986 to 1989, in Rajiv Gandhi's government.

Q.2 · Answer (B) Bodhchandra Singh
Maharaja Bodhchandra Singh signed Manipur's Instrument of Accession in 1947, and the agreement merging the state into India in 1949.

Q.4 · Answer (A) Manipur
Keibul Lamjao National Park floats on the phumdis, mats of floating vegetation, of Loktak Lake in Manipur.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Sesamum
NCERT notes that sesamum (til) is a kharif crop in the north and a rabi crop in south India. Wheat and barley are rabi crops, and finger millet (ragi) is mainly a kharif crop.

Q.6 · Answer (B) MS-DOS
SSC's key gives MS-DOS, the textbook single-user system: it has no user accounts or logins and serves one person at a time. Windows NT and Linux are multi-user systems, and Windows 7, built on Windows NT, keeps separate accounts and lets several users stay signed in at once, though some textbooks class desktop Windows as single-user.

Q.7 · Answer (C) Infantry School, Mhow
Asmi, India's first indigenous 9 mm machine pistol, was developed by DRDO's Armament Research and Development Establishment, Pune, with the Infantry School, Mhow.

Q.8 · Answer (D) 1024
In binary units 1 petabyte = 1,024 terabytes, just as 1 terabyte = 1,024 gigabytes.

Q.9 · Answer (A) 70%
The Economic Survey 2019-20 put the public sector banks' share of the Indian banking market at about 70%.

Q.10 · Answer (D) Nikolai Snesarev
In January 2021 the Belarusian Nikolai Snesarev was appointed again as middle- and long-distance coach of the Indian athletics team, a post he had left in 2019.

Q.11 · Answer (C) mass
Inertia, an object's resistance to a change in its state of rest or motion, depends on its mass: the greater the mass, the greater the inertia.

Q.12 · Answer (C) Talasari
In October 2020 eight Indian beaches received the Blue Flag, among them Kappad (Kerala), Ghoghla (Diu) and Rushikonda (Andhra Pradesh); Talasari in Odisha was not one of them.

Q.13 · Answer (C) e-Sampada
The Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs launched the e-Sampada portal and app on 25 December 2020, Good Governance Day, for the allotment of government accommodation and other estate services.

Q.14 · Answer (B) Alan Burgess
Alan Burgess, a first-class cricketer for Canterbury in New Zealand, served in the Second World War in Egypt and Italy; he died in January 2021, aged 100.

Q.15 · Answer (D) Article 48
Article 48, a Directive Principle, asks the State to organise agriculture and animal husbandry on modern and scientific lines.

Q.16 · Answer (A) Srinagar
Charar-e-Sharief, the shrine of the Sufi saint Sheikh Noor-ud-din Noorani (Nund Rishi), is in Budgam district, south-west of Srinagar.

Q.17 · Answer (B) Haryali
NCERT describes Haryali as a watershed development project sponsored by the Central Government to enable the rural population to conserve water for drinking, irrigation, fisheries and afforestation. Neeru-Meeru (Andhra Pradesh) and Arvary Pani Sansad (Alwar, Rajasthan) are state and local efforts.

Q.18 · Answer (D) Magadha
Magadha, with the forests of eastern India to supply them, was the first kingdom to use elephants on a large scale in its wars.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Rigveda
The Purusha Sukta is hymn 90 of the tenth book (mandala) of the Rigveda.

Q.20 · Answer (C) Bangladesh
Bangladesh was the Country in Focus at the 51st IFFI, held in Goa from 16 to 24 January 2021.

Q.21 · Answer (C) William Harvey
William Harvey described the circulation of the blood, pumped round the body by the heart, in 1628.

Q.22 · Answer (B) Kala-azar
Kala-azar (visceral leishmaniasis) is caused by Leishmania and spread by sandflies. Sleeping sickness is caused by Trypanosoma and malaria by Plasmodium.

Q.23 · Answer (A) Sandalwood
NCERT lists sandalwood among the main species of tropical moist deciduous forests, with teak, sal and shisham. Amaltas and neem belong to the drier deciduous forests and khejri to the thorn forests.

Q.24 · Answer (D) six
A shadava raga uses six notes; an audava raga uses five and a sampurna raga all seven.

Q.25 · Answer (D) centrally sponsored schemes

In the Budget 2021-22 statement of where the rupee goes, centrally sponsored schemes take 9 paise of every rupee; interest payments take 20 paise, defence 8 paise and pensions 5 paise.

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